

Denver Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services
1331 Cherokee Street, Denver, CO 80204

OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(720) 555-0183 | Emergency: 911

CASE NUMBER	DPD-26-12-11-2201	WEATHER	Blizzard (visibility < 200 ft, sustained winds 35 mph)
DATE OF INCIDENT	December 11, 2026	LIGHT CONDITIONS	Daylight / Whiteout conditions
TIME OF INCIDENT	14:22 hrs	ROADWAY SURFACE	Packed Snow / Drifting
LOCATION	I-70 Westbound, Mile Marker 262.1 (Sixth Ave Freeway interchange), Lakewood, CO 80401	TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES	5-vehicle pileup + jackknifed semi-truck / 6 units total

SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

Responding Agency	Denver Police Department
Investigating Officer	Officer Rachel L. Dunn, Badge #5519
Officer Phone	(720) 555-0183 ext. 618
EMS Agency	Lakewood Fire Dept. — Medic 4 and Medic 9 (transported five occupants); Flight for Life Colorado (one critical air transport)
Tow Companies	Rocky Mountain Towing (V1-V4); CDOT Emergency Services (Semi/V5)
Additional Units	Sgt. A. Fleming #3341; CSP Trooper K. Bauer; CDOT Incident Response Unit 7; Jefferson County SO Unit 22

SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

#	Year / Make / Model	VIN	Plate	Damage
V1	2020 Subaru Outback	4S4BSANC5L3241801	CO-APX-8821 (CO)	Rear bumper deformed; minor — drivable
V2	2019 Jeep Grand Cherokee	1C4RJFBG2KC841801	CO-BRT-4418 (CO)	Front and rear deformed — sandwiched; both airbags deployed; not drivable
V3	2022 Ford Explorer	1FMSK8DH9NGC48801	CO-CTW-7723 (CO)	Front bumper, hood, grille destroyed; airbag deployed; coolant loss
V4	2021 Dodge Ram 2500	3C6UR5DL9MG341801	CO-DLX-3319 (CO)	Front destroyed; frame bend; airbag deployed; towed — possible total loss
V5	2018 Peterbilt 389 (tractor-trailer, CMV)	1XPBDB9X5JD841801	CO-CMV-4412 (CO)	Jackknifed — trailer rotated 90 degrees; tractor cab front destroyed; trailer side panels buckled

SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS

Party	Name	DOB	License	Citation
Driver V1	Anna M. Kowalski	04/28/1985	CO-K44218301	None
Driver V2	Luis F. Herrera	11/07/1992	CO-H88234107	CO CRS §42-4-1008 — Following Too Close
Driver V3	Timothy R. Burns	07/14/1979	CO-B77187213	CO CRS §42-4-1008 — Following Too Close
Driver V4	Priya K. Singh	02/19/1996	CO-S44219812	CO CRS §42-4-1008 — Following Too Close
Operator V5 (CMV)	Wayne T. Buckley	09/03/1966	CO-CDL-B88241307	CO CRS §42-4-1008 — Following Too Close; FMCSA 49 CFR §392.14 — Hazardous Conditions

SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS

Veh	Name	DOB	Injury	Transported
V2	Carmen L. Herrera	03/14/1994	Serious: bilateral knee trauma, rib fracture, whiplash	Yes — Lakewood FD Medic 4, to St. Anthonys Hospital (serious)
V2	Diego A. Herrera	08/22/2017	Moderate: forehead laceration, airbag contact; child seat deformed	Yes — Lakewood FD Medic 4, to Childrens Hospital Colorado (stable)
V3	Susan E. Burns	12/01/1981	Serious: head laceration, loss of consciousness — suspected TBI	Yes — Flight for Life Colorado, to UCHHealth University of Colorado Hospital (critical air transport)
V3	Oliver T. Burns	05/17/2013	Moderate: cervical strain, airbag abrasion	Yes — Lakewood FD Medic 9, to Childrens Hospital Colorado (stable)
V4	Raj N. Singh	07/30/1998	Moderate: right arm laceration, shoulder contusion	Yes — Lakewood FD Medic 9, to St. Anthonys Hospital (stable)
V5	None (CMV — solo operator)	—	Operator Buckley — minor forehead laceration, declined transport	No — evaluated on scene, declined

SECTION 5 — WITNESSES

#	Name	Address	Phone	Statement
W1	Harold F. Grossman	Motorist, pulled to shoulder before collision; contact recorded	(720) 555-0374	Yes — observed full jackknife sequence of V5; written statement
W2	Tamara L. Bridwell	Passenger in following vehicle, stopped safely	(720) 555-0448	Yes — confirmed blizzard whiteout preceded the chain reaction; written statement
W3	CSP Trooper K. Bauer	Colorado State Patrol, Troop 2-C	(303) 555-0411	Yes — arrived at 14:38 hrs; supplemented scene investigation; CSP Report #CO-2026-1211-44 attached
W4	Elaine R. Cortez	Eastbound motorist, observed from opposite lanes	(720) 555-0519	Yes — described wall of snow and jackknifed trailer blocking view; verbal statement

SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)

	I-70 WB jersey barrier at Mile Marker 262.0 — struck by jackknifed trailer; three panels displaced. CDOT emergency repair crew dispatched. Highway overhead sign structure — minor contact from trailer swing arm.
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SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE

On Friday December 11, 2026 at approximately 14:22 hrs, this officer, Sgt. Fleming, and Colorado State Patrol Trooper Bauer responded to I-70 westbound at Mile Marker 262.1 near the Sixth Avenue Freeway interchange in Lakewood on report of a multi-vehicle crash with a jackknifed semi-truck and multiple serious injuries. A blizzard was in effect at the time, with sustained winds of 35 mph and visibility estimated at under 200 feet in the westbound corridor. The roadway was covered with packed snow and drifting obscured lane markings entirely. V1 (2020 Subaru Outback, Kowalski) was traveling westbound at a cautious reduced speed appropriate for blizzard conditions. V1 came to a near stop as the roadway narrowed ahead due to a prior snow maintenance vehicle. V2 (2019 Jeep Grand Cherokee, Herrera) was following V1 and failed to stop in time on the snow-packed surface, striking V1's rear at moderate speed. The impact pushed V1 forward and V2 came to rest across the center and right lanes. V3 (2022 Ford Explorer, Burns) was approaching from behind and struck the rear of V2 with significant force; V3's momentum carried it into V2 and partially into V1's right-rear corner. V4 (2021 Dodge Ram 2500, Singh) was following V3 and struck V3's rear, completing a four-car accordion. V5 (2018 Peterbilt 389, operator Buckley — Apex Freight LLC) was approaching the pileup at an estimated 55–60 mph — witness Grossman estimated this from the RPM sound and closing rate — and was unable to stop. Buckley applied brakes and attempted evasive steering but the tractor jackknifed on the snow surface, rotating the 53-foot trailer 90 degrees across all three westbound travel lanes and blocking the roadway entirely. The tractor cab struck V4 during the jackknife rotation. V3 passenger Susan Burns was found unresponsive with a serious head laceration and was transported by Flight for Life Colorado to UCHHealth University of Colorado Hospital under critical trauma protocol. V2 passenger Carmen Herrera was transported in serious condition to St. Anthony's Hospital with bilateral knee trauma and a rib fracture. V2 passenger Diego Herrera, age 8 (child safety seat, structural deformation noted), was transported to Children's Hospital Colorado in stable condition. V3 passenger Oliver Burns, age 13, was transported to Children's Hospital Colorado with cervical strain. V4 passenger Raj Singh was transported to St. Anthony's in stable condition with arm laceration. Operator Buckley sustained a minor forehead laceration and declined transport. Witness Harold Grossman was approximately 15 car lengths behind V5 and observed the full jackknife sequence. He stated the trailer swung rapidly and completely blocked his field of view, and he braked aggressively on the snow surface to avoid a sixth-vehicle involvement. Witness Tamara Bridwell described the moments before the pileup as a "sudden whiteout" that reduced visibility to near zero. CSP Trooper Bauer arrived at 14:38 hrs, assumed co-command of the scene, and filed CSP Report #CO-2026-1211-44 (attached). CDOT Incident Response Unit 7 arrived at 14:55 hrs and coordinated full closure of I-70 WB at Exit 265, with diversion to US-6. The closure remained in effect until 18:44 hrs.

SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — CMV JACKKNIFE INVESTIGATION AND CDOT COORDINATION: V5 (Peterbilt 389, Apex Freight LLC, USDOT #3114882) was placed out of service per FMCSA 49 CFR §396.9. CDOT Motor Carrier Services Inspector L. Padilla arrived at 15:20 hrs and conducted a Level I inspection. Preliminary findings: (1) Trailer brake adjustment — right rear tandem axle showing excessive travel. (2) Kingpin wear within spec. (3) Operator Buckley's electronic logging device (ELD) was checked on scene — showed 6.2 hours driving in the preceding 12 hours, within HOS limits. The full CMV inspection report and ELD download are pending and will be attached as Exhibits D and E upon completion. JACKKNIFE DYNAMICS: A crash reconstruction request has been submitted to the Colorado State Patrol Crash Reconstruction Unit due to the jackknife mechanism and critical injury to V3 passenger Burns. EDR download for V5 tractor cab has been requested. V2, V3, and V4 EDRs are also flagged for download pending court authorization. Reconstruction findings will supplement this report. FLIGHT FOR LIFE COORDINATION: Flight for Life Colorado Aircraft N821FL responded from their Denver base. Landing zone was established in the I-70 WB right shoulder at Mile Marker 261.5 with assistance from Lakewood FD and CDOT. V3 passenger Susan Burns was transported to UCHHealth University Hospital at 15:09 hrs. Medical update requested within 24 hours. CHILDREN'S HOSPITAL NOTIFICATIONS: Two child passengers transported. Diego Herrera (V2, age 8) child seat involved in moderate-to-severe crash; replacement recommended per NHTSA. Oliver Burns (V3, age 13) booster seat appeared structurally intact but replacement recommended. Resource forms provided to both families. I-70 CLOSURE IMPACT: The full westbound closure between Exits 262 and 265 from 14:51 to 18:44 hrs resulted in a 12-mile backup extending to I-225 per CDOT TIM logs. CDOT has been requested to provide weather station data for the MP 262 area for the period 12:00–15:00 hrs.

SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY

Party	Statute	Violation	Fine / Disposition
Driver V2 (Herrera)	CO CRS §42-4-1008	Following Too Close — blizzard/whiteout	Civil Penalty
Driver V3 (Burns)	CO CRS §42-4-1008	Following Too Close — blizzard/whiteout	Civil Penalty
Driver V4 (Singh)	CO CRS §42-4-1008	Following Too Close — blizzard/whiteout	Civil Penalty
Operator V5 (Buckley)	CO CRS §42-4-1008	Following Too Close — CMV blizzard conditions	Civil Penalty
Operator V5 (Buckley)	49 CFR §392.14	CMV operation in hazardous conditions	Federal — FMCSA

SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF

signed

Officer Rachel L. Dunn, Badge #5519

Investigating Officer, Denver Police Department Traffic Services

December 11, 2026

Date